

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Marketing English

Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Find the right language. Speak, write, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For brand, product marketing, growth, content, SEO, lifecycle, demand generation, marketing operations, social, and agency teams.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Marketing Strategy: Audience, Insight, Problem, Outcome

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Positioning, Messaging, Brand Voice, and Proof

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

03 Campaign Briefs, GTM Planning, and Cross-Functional Alignment

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

04 Content, SEO, Thought Leadership, and Editorial Judgment

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

05 Paid Media, Performance Marketing, and Attribution

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

06 Lifecycle, CRM, Email, Marketing Ops, and Sales Handoff

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

07 Analytics, Experimentation, Funnel Reporting, and Executive Readouts

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

08 Compliance, Privacy, Claims, Influencers, Brand Safety, and Crisis Response

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one case and saying a response. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, conversation, writing, and revision.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | Speak and respond

Give two minutes of preparation. Run the partner exchange, switch roles, and add the follow-up challenge. Observe whether the listener can act on the message.

35-47 minutes | Write for a real reader

Learners write the short message using only case facts. Partners check clarity, certainty, and the requested next step.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, shorten the first conversation and assign writing for follow-up. For 90 minutes, add 15 minutes for a second case and 15 minutes for the final challenge. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Marketing Strategy: Audience, Insight, Problem, Outcome

Clarify missing information before responding.

CASE

A campaign brief targets "everyone who works in an office." The product is a scheduling tool, but the buyer and daily user may differ.

Teach this move

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Vocabulary to check: Segment, ICP, Persona, JTBD.

Model response

Who decides to buy the tool, and who uses it each day? Let's define a specific audience and the problem we are solving before choosing the campaign message.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: what this means.

Second-round challenge

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Language-check answers

1. A - Could you confirm when the review starts? The embedded question uses subject then verb: the review starts.
2. C - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review? This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Positioning, Messaging, Brand Voice, and Proof

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

CASE

A draft advertisement says "the fastest tool on the market." The only evidence is an internal test against one earlier version.

Teach this move

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Vocabulary to check: Positioning, Value proposition, Proof point, Brand promise.

Model response

The test supports a comparison with our earlier version, not the whole market. Could we use a narrower claim that accurately describes what we measured and send it for review?

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Second-round challenge

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Language-check answers

1. C - The change may have contributed to the delay. 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.
2. B - In this pilot, the observed result was ... This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Campaign Briefs, GTM Planning, and Cross-Functional Alignment

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

CASE

A launch brief has a date and channel list but no audience, approved message, or measure of success.

Teach this move

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Vocabulary to check: Creative brief, GTM, Buyer journey, Sales enablement.

Model response

Could you add the primary audience, approved message, and success measure before Thursday's review? Those details will help the content and channel teams work toward the same outcome.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Second-round challenge

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Language-check answers

1. B - Send it no later than Thursday. 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.
2. A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review? The requested action and information are explicit.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Content, SEO, Thought Leadership, and Editorial Judgment

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

CASE

A proposed article targets a popular keyword, but searchers appear to want instructions while the draft is a product announcement.

Teach this move

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Vocabulary to check: Search intent, Keyword, SERP, Content brief.

Model response

The search intent appears to be instructional. Our draft announces a product instead. We could create a useful how-to article and include the product only where it helps answer the question.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Second-round challenge

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Language-check answers

1. A - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed. This gives the meaning in familiar words.
2. C - How would you describe the next step in your own words? An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Paid Media, Performance Marketing, and Attribution

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

CASE

Paid conversions rose after a campaign change, but a discount began in the same week. A slide credits the campaign with the entire increase.

Teach this move

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Vocabulary to check: Attribution, CPA, ROAS, Incrementality.

Model response

Conversions rose after the campaign change, but the discount is another possible influence. I'll describe the timing accurately and avoid claiming that the campaign caused the entire increase.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Second-round challenge

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Language-check answers

1. C - The change may have contributed to the delay. 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.
2. B - In this pilot, the observed result was ... This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Lifecycle, CRM, Email, Marketing Ops, and Sales Handoff

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

CASE

A lead list is ready for sales. It contains contact details but no explanation of which contacts requested a conversation.

Teach this move

State the current situation, relevant background, open task, and receiving role. Ask for acknowledgment or repeat-back of the critical item. Sending a message and transferring responsibility are not always the same thing.

Vocabulary to check: MQL, SQL, Nurture, Suppression list.

Model response

The handoff needs the agreed qualification fields and contact permissions. I'll distinguish conversation requests from other activity so sales can choose an appropriate follow-up under our process.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence asks for an identifiable receiving team instead of leaving responsibility with an unspecified 'someone'.

Second-round challenge

The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Language-check answers

1. B - Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check. It asks for an identifiable person or team responsible for the task.
2. A - So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct? This repeats the status and responsibility and invites correction.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Analytics, Experimentation, Funnel Reporting, and Executive Readouts

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

CASE

An email experiment records 120 clicks from 2,000 delivered messages in version A and 140 from 2,000 in version B. No significance analysis is complete.

Teach this move

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

Vocabulary to check: CTR, Lift test, Cohort, Vanity metric.

Model response

The observed click rates are 6% and 7%. Version B is higher in this sample, but we have not established whether the difference is reliable. Let's complete the planned analysis before naming a winner.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Second-round challenge

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Language-check answers

1. A - The team has completed the review. 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.
2. C - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it. This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Compliance, Privacy, Claims, Influencers, Brand Safety, and Crisis Response

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

CASE

A scheduled post includes a claim that reviewers have asked to revise. The post has not yet been published.

Teach this move

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

Vocabulary to check: Substantiation, Material connection, Consent, Brand safety.

Model response

The scheduled wording differs from the reviewed claim. I'll pause publication through our process and send the revised copy for approval. Please confirm which version should replace it.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

Second-round challenge

The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Language-check answers

1. C - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear. This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.
2. B - The corrected date and the current confirmation status. A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.